

Your Bathroom Remodel Checklist

Tailored to Your Project

Full Gut Renovation | Guilford, CT

Prepared for Claudia • April 15, 2026



Your vision, realized — a complete bathroom transformation from studs to stunning.

Project Overview

This checklist has been customized for your specific project scope: a **full gut renovation** of your bathroom in Guilford, Connecticut. It covers every phase from permits and planning through final inspections, and is tailored to reflect local

Guilford permitting requirements, Connecticut building codes, and the specific trades and tasks involved in your remodel.

Use this as your master tracking document. Check off each item as it is completed and share it with your general contractor to keep everyone aligned.

Your Project Scope at a Glance

Category	Scope Details
Renovation Type	Full gut renovation — demolition to studs, new layout
Fixtures	New tub/shower, toilet, vanity/sink — same locations
Tile Work	New floor tile and wall/shower surround tile
Plumbing	Moving or adding supply and drain lines
Electrical	New lighting, GFCI outlets, exhaust fan, heated floors
Estimated Timeline	4-8 weeks (construction phase, not counting design/ordering)
Location	Guilford, CT — permits through Guilford Building Department

PHASE 1: PRE-CONSTRUCTION PLANNING

— Weeks 1-3

Permits & Approvals

- ☐ Obtain Zoning Permit from Guilford Zoning Department
- ☐ Apply for Building Permit via Guilford Online Permit Portal
- ☐ Apply for separate Plumbing Permit (\$50 recording fee)
- ☐ Apply for separate Electrical Permit (\$50 recording fee)
- ☐ Calculate permit fees: \$0.60/sq ft renovation area + state surcharge

- ☐ Confirm all permits are issued before any work begins

Important — Guilford Permit Policy

All permits must be submitted through the **Guilford Online Permit Portal** — no paper applications are accepted. Permits are valid for one year from the date of issue. Do not begin any construction work until all permits are in hand.

Design & Planning

- ☐ Finalize bathroom layout / floor plan (existing vs. proposed)
- ☐ Select all fixtures: tub/shower unit, toilet, vanity/sink, faucets
- ☐ Select tile for floor and shower surround/walls (confirm slip-resistance rating for floor tile)
- ☐ Choose lighting fixtures (vanity lights, recessed/can lights, shower-rated fixture)
- ☐ Select exhaust fan (must be vented to exterior per CT code — minimum 50 CFM for standard bath)
- ☐ Decide on heated floor system (electric mat vs. hydronic) and select thermostat
- ☐ Choose paint colors and moisture-resistant wall finishes
- ☐ Order all materials — allow 4-8 week lead time for specialty items
- ☐ Establish project budget and contingency (recommend 15-20% buffer for gut reno)

Tip — Lead Times Matter

Specialty tile, custom vanities, and imported fixtures can take 4-8 weeks to arrive. Order materials as early as possible to avoid costly delays once

demolition begins. Have all materials on-site or confirmed before your contractor's start date.

Contractor Coordination

- ☐ Confirm GC has valid Connecticut contractor license
- ☐ Confirm GC has current liability insurance
- ☐ Obtain and sign written contract with detailed scope of work
- ☐ Confirm subcontractor lineup: licensed CT plumber, licensed CT electrician
- ☐ Set project start date and estimated timeline (typical full gut bath: 4-8 weeks)
- ☐ Discuss waste disposal / dumpster placement

PHASE 2: DEMOLITION

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ROUGH-IN

— Weeks 4-5

Demolition

- ☐ Shut off water supply to bathroom
- ☐ Disconnect and remove existing fixtures (tub/shower, toilet, vanity)
- ☐ Remove existing tile (floor and walls)
- ☐ Strip walls to studs / remove drywall or plaster
- ☐ Remove existing flooring down to subfloor

- ☐ Inspect subfloor for water damage or rot — replace as needed
- ☐ Inspect framing and joists for structural integrity
- ☐ Check for and remediate any mold or asbestos (homes pre-1980s especially)
- ☐ Dispose of demolition debris properly (confirm dumpster or haul-away)

Warning — Hazardous Materials

Many Guilford homes were built before 1980. If your home falls in this category, assume that asbestos, lead paint, or both may be present in old tile, flooring adhesive, plaster, or pipe insulation. **Do not disturb suspect materials without professional testing.** Connecticut law requires licensed abatement contractors for asbestos removal.

Rough Plumbing

- ☐ Install or relocate supply lines (hot and cold) for new fixture positions
- ☐ Install or relocate drain/waste/vent (DWV) lines per new layout
- ☐ Install shower valve rough-in (confirm valve meets CT code — anti-scald/pressure-balancing required)
- ☐ Install toilet flange at correct height for new flooring
- ☐ Ensure proper venting for all fixtures (each fixture needs code-compliant vent)
- ☐ Pressure test all new supply lines

Rough Electrical

- ☐ Run new circuits as needed (bathroom requires dedicated 20-amp circuit per NEC)
- ☐ Install boxes for all light fixtures, switches, exhaust fan
- ☐ Install GFCI-protected outlets (required within 3 feet of water source per CT/NEC code)
- ☐ Run wiring for heated floor system (typically requires dedicated circuit)
- ☐ Run wiring for exhaust fan (confirm fan will be ducted to exterior, not into attic)
- ☐ Install low-voltage wiring if needed (smart mirror, Bluetooth speaker, etc.)

Framing & Structural

- ☐ Frame or reframe any wall changes per new layout
- ☐ Install blocking in walls for grab bars, towel bars, heavy fixtures
- ☐ Reinforce floor joists if needed for heavy tub (cast iron, freestanding)
- ☐ Frame shower niche(s) if planned



CRITICAL — Rough-In Inspections Required Before Closing Walls

Connecticut and Guilford building codes require that all rough-in work be inspected and approved **before** walls are closed up. Do not proceed to drywall or backer board until all of the following pass:

- ☐ **Rough plumbing inspection** — call Guilford Building Department
- ☐ **Rough electrical inspection** — call Guilford Building Department
- ☐ **Rough framing inspection** (if structural changes were made)
- ☐ **ALL rough inspections must PASS before proceeding to Phase 3**

PHASE 3: SURFACES

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INSTALLATION

— Weeks 6-7

Waterproofing & Substrate

- ☐ Install moisture-resistant backer board (cement board or equivalent) on walls in wet areas
- ☐ Apply waterproof membrane to shower walls and floor (e.g., Kerdi, RedGard, or liquid membrane)
- ☐ Waterproof shower curb and seat (if applicable)
- ☐ Install cement backer board or appropriate subfloor prep for floor tile
- ☐ Confirm shower pan / base is properly sloped to drain ($\frac{1}{4}$ " per foot minimum)

Tip — Waterproofing Is Non-Negotiable

The waterproofing layer is the single most important step in preventing future water damage. Ensure your contractor applies membrane to **all** wet-area surfaces — including the shower curb, bench seams, and any niches. A failure here can mean tearing out the entire shower within a few years.

Tile Installation

- ☐ Install shower wall tile and any accent/niche tile
- ☐ Install floor tile (confirm slip-resistance for bathroom use)

- ☐ Grout all tile — use mold-resistant grout
- ☐ Seal grout lines
- ☐ Install tile trim and transition pieces

Drywall & Paint

- ☐ Install moisture-resistant drywall (green board or purple board) on non-tiled walls
- ☐ Tape, mud, and finish drywall seams
- ☐ Prime and paint with moisture-resistant bathroom paint (semi-gloss or satin finish recommended)

Heated Floor

- ☐ Install electric floor heating mat per manufacturer specifications
- ☐ Test heated floor system **before** covering with tile
- ☐ Install floor tile over heating mat
- ☐ Install thermostat/control for heated floor

Important — Test Before Tiling

Always perform a full resistance test of the heated floor mat **before** tile is installed. Once tile is set over a damaged mat, repair requires removing the entire floor. Document the test results for your warranty records.

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FIXTURES

— Week 8

Fixture Installation

- ☐ Install bathtub or shower base/enclosure
- ☐ Install shower door or curtain rod
- ☐ Install toilet
- ☐ Install vanity and sink
- ☐ Install all faucets and shower trim (handle, showerhead, tub spout)
- ☐ Connect all fixture supply and drain lines

Electrical Finish

- ☐ Install light fixtures (vanity, overhead, shower-rated)
- ☐ Install GFCI outlets and cover plates
- ☐ Install exhaust fan and connect duct to exterior
- ☐ Install switches and dimmers
- ☐ Install heated floor thermostat

Final Details

- ☐ Install mirror/medicine cabinet
- ☐ Install towel bars, robe hooks, toilet paper holder, accessories
- ☐ Install grab bars (recommended even if not required — blocking installed in Phase 2)

- ☐ Apply caulk at all fixture-to-wall and fixture-to-floor joints (use mold-resistant silicone)
- ☐ Install baseboard/trim
- ☐ Install bathroom door hardware
- ☐ Final clean of all surfaces

PHASE 5: INSPECTIONS

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CLOSE-OUT

— Final Week

- ☐ Schedule **final building inspection** with Guilford Building Department
- ☐ Schedule **final plumbing inspection**
- ☐ Schedule **final electrical inspection**
- ☐ Address any inspector corrections or punch list items
- ☐ Obtain Certificate of Occupancy (\$50 for single-family residence)

Administrative Close-Out

- ☐ Obtain final lien waivers from contractor and all subcontractors
- ☐ Collect all warranty information (fixtures, tile, waterproofing, heated floor)
- ☐ Collect all product manuals and care instructions
- ☐ Retain copies of all permits, inspection reports, and receipts
- ☐ Do a final walkthrough with contractor — note any remaining punch list items

 Tip — Protect Yourself

Lien waivers are essential. Before making your final payment, obtain signed lien waivers from your general contractor **and** every subcontractor and material supplier. This protects you from future claims against your property for unpaid work or materials.

Quick-Reference Timeline

Phase	Timing	Key Milestones
Phase 1	Weeks 1-3	Permits issued, materials ordered, contract signed
Phase 2	Weeks 4-5	Demolition complete, rough-ins installed, all rough inspections passed
Phase 3	Weeks 6-7	Waterproofing complete, tile installed, heated floor tested, walls painted
Phase 4	Week 8	All fixtures installed, electrical finished, accessories mounted, final clean
Phase 5	Final Week	All final inspections passed, CO obtained, warranties collected, walkthrough complete

Guilford Building Department — Key Contacts

Phone: (203) 453-8029 | **Email:** building.perm@guilfordct.gov

Permits: All permits submitted through the Guilford Online Permit Portal — no paper applications accepted.

Permit Validity: Permits are valid for one year from the date of issue.

Notes & Reminders

- Typical full gut bathroom renovation timeline: **4-8 weeks** (not counting design and ordering phase).
- **Budget tip:** Plan for a 15–20% contingency on a gut renovation — surprises behind the walls are common, especially in older Guilford homes.
- Keep a dedicated folder (physical or digital) for all permits, inspection reports, contracts, warranties, and receipts. You will need these for future home sale disclosures and any warranty claims.
- Communicate with your contractor at least weekly — a short check-in prevents small issues from becoming expensive problems.

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This checklist is a planning guide and does not constitute professional construction, legal, or code-compliance advice. Always consult licensed professionals and your local building department for project-specific requirements.